

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader who still builds — UX maturity raised at Ninox and Datameer, AI shipped into production

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany · open to the Munich area

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I still build. The last year went into AI that runs in production — a support copilot, a fundraising system I built end to end, and prototypes engineering ships from. Before that, fifteen years of enterprise B2B — raising UX maturity at Ninox and Datameer, and stakeholder work across a 200-person matrix organization at Spreadshirt.

70% / 90%

less coordination time, and acceptance at the launch customer — on the capability I argued into the platform rather than beside it

Four employers

research owned end to end at each, from regulated banks at Datameer to viewers at Bibel TV

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- AI support copilot, live in production — assistive drafting for viewer letters in the handbook's wording. A restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, and every send decision stays human.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end — analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill generating follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Agentic engineering as a design practice — prototypes run on real APIs and the agency ships from that code.
- Product strategy for the platform — competitive analysis against global entrants to the German market, and a differentiation strategy built on local content.
- Design system as an API, and the tooling on top of it — DTCG tokens and multi-platform sync, built without a platform team.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Product management and design at once — owned the main platform as PM alongside all product design.
- The decision I defended through the build — inherited a €20k client-funded project scoped as a standalone add-on and reframed it into a platform capability.
- AI alt-text in production — shipped for EU accessibility compliance under GDPR plus Protestant and Catholic church data-protection law, across six countries.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US; the company was growing) Berlin, Germany

- UX maturity assessed with the team, not declared at it — Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead. I ran a self-assessment with the design team so the goals we set were ones the organization could actually support.
- Hired two, promoted two. Coached the design lead through a difficult cross-functional relationship.
- Interim Head of Product, July to October 2023 — then hired the consultant who was subsequently brought in as Head of Product.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE — 100+ people) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation — partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.
- Methodology transfer — ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams, as the primary stakeholder contact for the program.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years — two UX designers reporting to me. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- UX maturity, measurably increased — moved design from an execution function to a strategic partner and secured executive support for user research.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers. The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

UX Maturity and Function Leadership

UX maturity raised twice: at Ninox a self-assessment realigned the team with what the organization could support; at Datameer it rose measurably, with executive support secured for research · Instrumental in the UX maturity transformation at Spreadshirt, across a 200+ person matrix organization · A UX-maturity self-assessment used to align a dissatisfied team with what the organization could actually support · UX standards and shared design-system governance

People and Performance

Senior Leadership Team member · 5 direct reports including a design lead · Hired two, promoted two · Coaching a design lead through cross-functional conflict · Team norms redesigned so the quietest contributor became one of the strongest · Hired a Head of Product into a role I was covering

Product Strategy and Executive Partnership

Product management of a platform alongside its design · Interim Head of Product · Roadmap ownership · Executive partnership on a service-to-product transformation · A product-strategy assumption reversed with user research · C-level presentation across four employers

Research Practice

Iterative useresting.com screening for personas inside regulated institutions · Research protocols and executive sponsorship secured · Dovetail as a shared insight repository · Claude over thousands of forum posts, and Teams transcription into Claude for interviews · The threshold — AI analysis above a few hundred data points, direct reading below

AI in Production

Customer-support copilot live in production · AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end · Human-in-the-loop by design: manually operated and embedded in nothing, so the send decision stays human · Agentic engineering with Claude Code on real APIs · Design system as an API · DTCG tokens · Style Dictionary

Enterprise, Regulated and Multi-Market

Vertical ERP across six countries · No-code business platform across DACH / UK / US · Top US / CA / UK banks and insurers · HIPAA-compliant analytics platform · GDPR plus church data-protection law · EU accessibility compliance shipped · German native, English C2